

Welcome to Unix for design

If you work in digital design or verification, you will live in a shell

Why the shell matters

- Chip and verification work sits on real files and real tools
- A graphical editor helps you write RTL, but Make, Git, Icarus, Verilator
- Getting comfortable here pays off in every later course

Two tracks, one idea

- Every lab module offers two ways to practice
- Scripts feel real
- The browser lab track uses interactive tools on the learning platform
- You may do either track, or both
- The usual rhythm is browser first for the idea, then the real shell for muscle memory

Set up the real Unix track

- Open a terminal
- On Windows, prefer WSL, Windows Subsystem for Linux, so you get a real Unix shell
- From the learn Unix course folder, run the scaffold script once
- It does not install course tools
- You will come back to that tree throughout the course

Set up the browser lab track

- From the monorepo
- Serving the folder means your browser can load the interactive labs as ordinary web pages
- If you prefer, use the published tools site instead
- Either way, you only need to confirm you can reach the labs, the next module will send you

How to move through modules

- For each module
- When you finish this intro checklist, continue to the first lab module